

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global

- Full-time: 69%
- Freelance/Contract: 16.4%
- Student: 13.2%

United States

- Full-time (2023): 69%
- Full-time (2024): 64.8%

Non-full-time respondents lean toward independent contracting in the UK and Ukraine, while in Germany and India they are more likely to be students.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

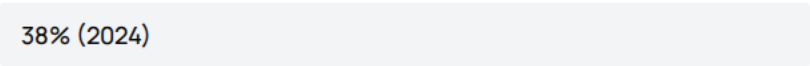
In-Person



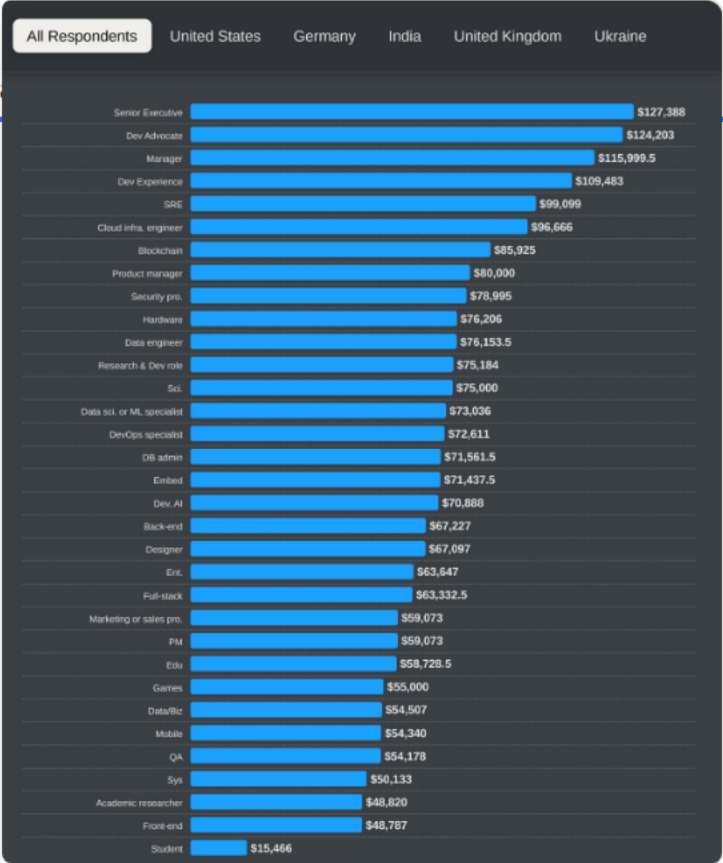
Hybrid



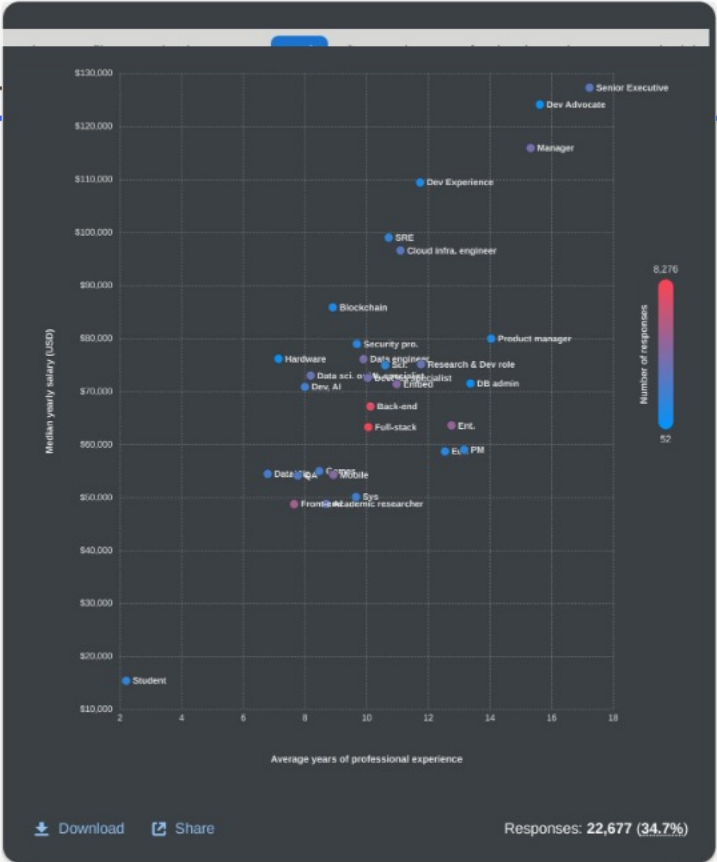
Remote



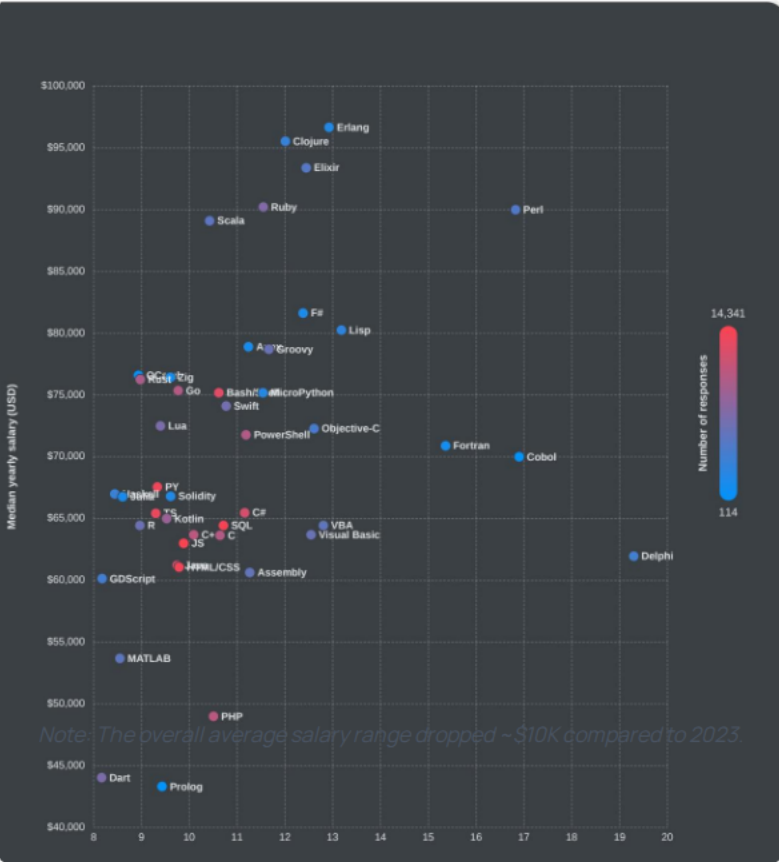
Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median



Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-



Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog



47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company Size

- **47%** work in orgs with <100 employees
- **21.2%** work at 20–99 employees
- **Only 11.4%** at enterprises (10,000+)

Purchasing Influence

- **62%** influence tech purchases
- **60%** prefer a build-and-buy approach
- **Top evaluation methods:** Starting a free trial (75%), Asking other devs (73%)

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

- **Full-time employment softening:** Plan for more contractors and freelancers, especially in the US and UK.
- **In-person mandates growing:** Now at 20%, but hybrid (42%) is still dominant.
- **DevRel and SRE command premium pay:** Top roles require competitive compensation and 10+ years experience.
- **Niche languages pay more:** Erlang and Clojure top the charts, while mainstream languages lag.
- **Developers influence purchasing:** Engage individual contributors directly through free trials and community channels.